AMAN TRIPATHI

Product, Strategy & Operations Leader▪Hardware & Autonomous Systems▪0→1 for Multi-Billion Program
San Francisco, CA ▪ aman.tripathi@berkeley.edu ▪ +1 510-944-2283 ▪ LinkedIn Profile

SUMMARY

Product leader with 11 years across autonomy, mobility, automotive and industrial technology – the last eight leading products for Wisk Aero's (Boeing) autonomous electric vertical takeoff and landing (eVTOL) passenger aircraft. Lead Wisk's product strategy, business case, and commercialization plans. Own the product requirements, unit economics, and go-to-market that guide 1000+ engineers along with defining the "what" and "why" behind company products. Built the business case and helped raise >$1Bn in funds to date. Serve as the central integration point for product decisions across engineering, operations, finance, and production. Supported strategic partnerships with large private and public companies and developed GTM blueprints for autonomous service. Co-author of Wisk-Boeing Concept of Operations, ICAO AAM Group advisor, inventor on five U.S. patent applications, and published with NASA to influence the roadmap of the nascent AAM industry. Previously launched a new high-rate engine manufacturing facility at Caterpillar and have deep expertise in business systems (MES, ERP, and PLM) and operations design.

Core strengths: Product management (0→1) for multi-billion program▪Product strategy▪Strategic finance▪Business cases & unit economics▪GTM, partnerships, & commercialization▪Partnering with engineering to define products▪Safety-critical & regulated products▪CAD/MES/ERP/PLM & NPI & factory setup▪Applied data science & simulation▪AI & machine learning▪Executive comms▪Industry vision papers

EXPERIENCE

Wisk Aero (a Boeing Company) – Mountain View, CA
Aug 2018 – Present

Product & Commercialization Lead

Product lead for Generation 6 autonomous eVTOL aircraft / air taxi & its passenger service and Wisk's future products – spanning product strategy, business case, go-to-market, and strategic partnerships.

Product Management, Strategy, and Leadership

- Own product requirements (MR&Os) for the Gen 6 autonomous aircraft and air-taxi service; set product direction by balancing market demand, engineering feasibility, certification, & unit economics.
- Helped define and now own 100+ product and service requirements that anchor the technical roadmap for 1000+ engineers across a 10+ year development and certification program.
- Own program KPIs – range, payload, charge time, noise, cost per seat-mile, battery and BOM cost – targets that drove motor and battery-pack sizing and now shape supply-chain sourcing strategy.
- Lead product strategy and develop PRDs for Wisk's next generation long-range products – including cargo & defense; develop market sizing (TAM/SAM/SOM) & lead customer discovery to validate PRDs.
- Co-authored the Wisk–Boeing Concept of Operations for integrating autonomous aircraft into the U.S. National Airspace System – now referenced by global standards bodies and covered by major media.
- Set the technical product direction by partnering with systems engineering to decompose the MR&Os & ConOps into use cases, behaviors, & hundreds of requirements for Wisk's core autonomy systems.
- Directly manage an analyst and a strategy contractor; previously led three rotational engineers and also had indirect management of 8 software engineers for a simulation tool development for a year.

Business case, Fundraising, and GTM

- Built the financial models and investor materials used by Wisk leadership in fundraising; supported >$1Bn raised to date; owned the economics and commercial inputs that feed executive decisions.

- Led Wisk's Long-Range Business Plan, defining multi-year capital allocation – at least $400M per year – across 50+ teams; the plan now governs company-wide resource planning.
- Authored the Los Angeles go-to-market and entry-into-service blueprint; LA is now one of Wisk's three finalized launch markets, with 6+ vertiports and 10+ partners selected.

Partnerships, Data science, and Operations

- Shaped partnerships with NASA, Skyports, Jeppesen, UPS, and SkyGrid – influenced NASA's AAM project direction and simulations, and SkyGrid's product roadmap ahead of its acquisition by Wisk.
- Established a team to design novel IFR flight routes for autonomous aircraft – now being tested in Texas under the FAA eVTOL Integration Pilot Program and in NASA simulations.
- Built Python analytics and simulation tools for market sizing, throughput, range, and weather; outputs feed product requirements and GTM strategy via SCOPE, Wisk's product-intelligence platform.
- Set up PLM/ERP/MES architecture to support FAA production certification; led ERP and MES projects.

Caterpillar Inc – Chennai, India Jul 2014 – Jun 2017

Manufacturing & Design Engineer

- As Technical Program Manager and Industrial Engineer, drove the NPI program that stood up a $10M+ engine assembly facility (20K units/yr) from concept through process validation to volume production.
- Owned manufacturing process plans for 20+ engine variants – work instructions, PFMEAs, control plans, BOMs, and engineering changes – and led MES and ERP deployment for the facility.
- Improved takt time from 14 → 10 minutes to reach planned capacity; coordinated 10+ vendors to design, deliver, and qualify factory equipment & conveyors, and trained 30+ production operators.

Other experience:

- **Manufacturing Eng Intern, Faraday Future (2018) –** Helped set up the manual pilot assembly line for final assembly of the FF91 electric vehicle; established its NCR and deviation management process.
- **Graduate Instructor, UC Berkeley (2018) –** taught "Physics for Future Presidents" to 400+ students.
- **Research Assistant (DAAD WISE Fellow), TU Berlin (2013) –** European Union (EU) SUSTRAIL rail-freight optimization; proposed an optimal wheel profile validated against the Manchester Benchmarks.

EDUCATION

University of California, Berkeley, USA — M.Eng., Operations Research 2018
Fung Fellowship • Coursework: machine learning, data science, optimization

National Institute of Technology (NIT) Warangal, India — B.Tech., Mechanical Engineering 2014
Department Rank 1 • GPA 4.0/4.0 • Dean's List and Merit Scholar every year

Politecnico di Torino, Turin, Italy 2014
Erasmus Mundus Scholar (EU), Final-year exchange, Automotive Engineering

PATENTS, PUBLICATIONS, INDUSTRY LEADERSHIP & RECOGNITION

- Lead or co-author of 6 papers – including 2 joint papers with NASA – in top journals and conferences.
- AIAA 30/30 recipient; Inventor on five U.S. patent applications in autonomous flight operations.
- Advisor, ICAO AAM Study Group – UN group harmonizing AAM framework for member states.
- Member, TRB (National Academies of Sciences) Standing Committee on Aviation Market Economics.
- Co-author of two widely referenced Concepts of Operations (Wisk-Boeing; Wisk-Skyports).
- Featured speaker: AIAA Aviation, TRB Aviation Symposium, Ohio State, Embry-Riddle, and others.
- Personal work featured in Aerospace America (AIAA Flagship Magazine) & Aviation & Defense Universe
- Authored a business case study for UW's Foster School of Business for 480+ students, 65+ teams.